Tag Helpers help reduce the duplication in your code, or they can simplify common patterns. In this section I show how you can create your own custom Tag Helpers.

In section 32.1.1 you'll create a system information Tag Helper, which prints details about the name and operating system of the server your app is running on. In section 32.1.2 you'll create a Tag Helper that you can use to conditionally show or hide an element based on a C# Boolean property. In section 32.1.3 you'll create a Tag Helper that reads the Razor content written inside the Tag Helper and transforms it.

32.1.1 Printing environment information with a custom Tag Helper

A common problem you may run into when you start running your web applications in production, especially if you're using a server-farm setup, is working out which machine rendered the page you're currently looking at. Similarly, when deploying frequently, it can be useful to know which version of the application is running. When I'm developing and testing, I sometimes like to add a little "info dump" at the bottom of my layouts so I can easily work out which server generated the current page, which environment it's running in, and so on.

In this section I'm going to show you how to build a custom Tag Helper to output system information to your layout. You'll be able to toggle the information it displays, but by default it displays the machine name and operating system on which the app is running, as shown in figure 32.1.